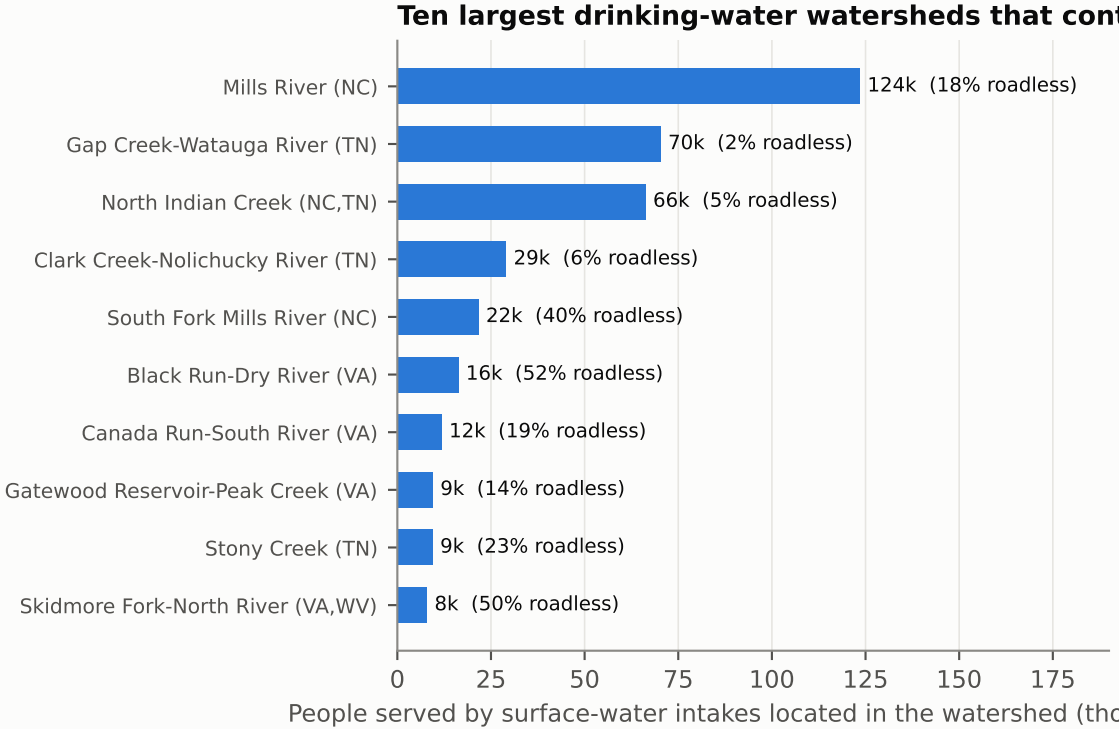
Drinking water: hundreds of thousands of people draw from watersheds containing roadless land



231 HUC12 watersheds contain 500+ acres of roadless land

98 surface-water intakes located in them

454k people served by those intakes

1.8M served in or within 5 watersheds downstream (lower bound)

Depending on how much roadless land a watershed must contain, population served ranges from 258k to 534k. For comparison, the DEIS (Table 35) reports 378 intakes serving 614,600 people for the whole Southern Region.

Sources: USFS Forests to Faucets 2.0 (HUC12; SDWIS-derived intake counts and populations); 2001 IRA inventory.
Populations count consumers of intakes located in each watershed; they are not estimates of people affected by land use.